

Russell Dudek

CANDIDATE FOR DIRECTOR, PROCESS EXCELLENCE - PROCESS AUTOMATION



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Hiring Team

USAA

USAA's Process Automation director has a deceptively difficult mandate: improve member and employee experiences through automation while making risk, ownership, and control evidence more - not less - visible. The role description's emphasis on BPM strategy, Process Engineers, portfolio selection, RPA platforms, process intelligence, measurable business cases, and embedded regulatory expectations makes that contradiction the center of the job.

I have spent my career making complex work operational. At Compunetics, I led engineering, manufacturing, quality, and high-reliability programs while building quality systems, root-cause practices, measures, and process controls. At Amazon, I built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation, and standard work in a 24/7 operation supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. Today at Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, support, engineering issue flow, ERP, CRM, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.

My candidate vision proposes an **Automation Assurance Twin**: a paired view of the work plane that changes the member or employee experience and the assurance plane that defines ownership, human authority, evidence, monitoring, and fallback. It is designed to help a COE decide whether to redesign, assist, automate, or standardize - and to connect each decision to specific value and control evidence. The full model and 120-day entry plan are available at russelldudek.github.io/USAA/.

I will not overstate the transfer. My verified record does not establish direct ownership of USAA's current RPA platform or a financial-services automation COE. It does establish process-engineering leadership, automation opportunity design, high-reliability controls, cross-functional operating mechanisms, and the ability to coach teams through measurable change. I would enter by learning the platform and regulatory context quickly, partnering with specialists, and proving fit through a bounded portfolio review.

I am based in Pittsburgh and have been planning a move to the Tampa/St. Petersburg region, so I recognize the four-day in-office requirement and would not depend on relocation assistance. One qualification item should also be verified before submission: my record states Six Sigma Certification but does not currently document a Green Belt level or three named Lean/Six Sigma projects.

I would value a conversation about where USAA most needs this leader to change the automation system: selection, controls, platform strategy, value realization, team capability, or all five.

Carpe diem,

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